Talk Light Trigger

Quick reference — controls & first-run setup

Listens to a talkback mic/bus input and fires a dLive Scene recall whenever the level crosses a threshold — one Scene while quiet, a different one while talkback is active. Point each Scene's Surface Illumination at a different colour and the console's lights flash with talkback.

Menu bar icon

Click	Show / hide the control panel.
Right-click	Quit the app (there's no Dock icon or app menu — this is the only way to quit).
Icon colour	Grey = stopped. Blue = running, listening (quiet). Bright = talkback active. **Amber, pulsing** = running but not reaching the console: MIDI Bridge or the console isn't there (the same amber MIDI Bridge shows while it connects).

Connection

MIDI Bridge	Talk Light reaches the console through the free **MIDI Bridge**, which holds the one connection to the MixRack for all your dylanmaudio apps. Set the console's IP address and base MIDI channel there, once; this app uses them, and shows as "Talk Light Trigger" in its MIDI Monitor.
The link line	Says whether the console is reached. **Green**: connected, and to which console. **Amber**: MIDI Bridge is running but not connected to the console — check the console IP and network in MIDI Bridge. **Red**: MIDI Bridge isn't running (**Open MIDI Bridge**) or isn't installed (**Get MIDI Bridge**).
Direct TCP / Existing MIDI Port	Kept in this version only, for setups that already use them: the panel says so, with **Move to MIDI Bridge**. They will be removed in the next version. A setup already on MIDI Bridge's MIDI port moves over by itself.

Audio Input

Device	The audio interface carrying the talkback signal.
Channel	Which input channel on that device to listen to.

Scenes

Quiet Scene #	Scene recalled while the input is below threshold.
Talkback Scene #	Scene recalled while talkback is active.
Flash Rate	While talkback is active, the app alternates the Quiet and Talkback Scenes at this rate instead of holding on the Talkback Scene — the console lights actually flash.
Flash Hold	How long the flash carries on after talkback stops (default 3 s), so a short pause doesn't cut the lights off. Talking again inside the hold just keeps it going. **Off** = the flash follows the microphone exactly.

Important — on the console, save two Scenes with different dimmer values in Surface → Control → Dimmer. Both Scenes must have their Recall Filter restricted to Surface Illumination only. Without this, recalling either Scene changes the whole mix, not just the lights.

Sensitivity

Threshold	Level the input has to cross to count as “talking.”
Attack Time	Time above Threshold required before it triggers (avoids brief noise/breath sounds).
Release	How far below Threshold the level must drop before counting as quiet again (avoids flicker at the edge).
Min Retrigger	Minimum time between Scene recalls, even if the level keeps crossing back and forth.

Cancel SoftKey

Heard through MIDI Bridge. This is the only thing in this app that ever receives MIDI; audio input still decides quiet vs. talking on its own.

Enable	Listens for a console SoftKey to stop the flash the moment it’s pressed.
Cancel CC #	The Control Change number your SoftKey sends (default 127).
What to type on the console	Set the SoftKey to **Custom MIDI** and type the string the panel shows, exactly — it follows the CC # and the base MIDI channel set in MIDI Bridge. It is three comma-separated hex bytes: **B** + (base channel – 1) in hex, the CC # in hex, then **01**. Base channel 12, CC 127 → **BB,7F,01**; base channel 1, CC 127 → **B0,7F,01**.
Cancel Cooldown	How long the flash stays off after a press. It resumes on its own after this, if still talking — no need to press again.

Running it

Start / Stop	Opens (or closes) the audio input and begins (or stops) watching the level. Start doesn’t wait for the console: if MIDI Bridge isn’t connected yet, it arms, says so in red, and the lights follow as soon as it connects.
Status tile	Stopped / Quiet / Active — mirrors the menu bar icon colour. Red = not reaching the console, with the reason.
First launch	macOS will prompt for microphone access the first time you click Start — allow it, or the app won’t receive any audio.

Bitfocus Companion

Connects on 127.0.0.1:8771 — the “Bitfocus Companion” row in the panel shows whether it's connected.

Allow Companion control	On by default (this Mac only). Companion can press Run and adjust Threshold; turn off to stop accepting remote presses — the panel still shows why.
Lock show-critical controls	Off by default. When on, Companion can’t switch Run off (turning it on remains available).
What Companion sees	Run/Threshold as buttons, plus Running, Talk state, Level, Threshold and both Scene numbers as variables and feedbacks.

If something goes wrong

Red: Not reaching the console	The line under it says what's missing: start MIDI Bridge, or check the console IP and network in MIDI Bridge. When the connection is back, the Scene for the current state is sent again, so the lights are right.
Export log	Click **Export log** in the panel footer. A diagnostics zip lands on your Desktop and opens in Finder — this session's log, the previous one, and your settings (licence details removed). Send that zip with your report; nothing leaves your Mac unless you send it.
What the log holds	Your settings at launch and each change, the audio and MIDI devices present, every Start and Stop, every error the panel showed you, your licence or trial state. Every launch is logged automatically; nothing to switch on.
The log folder	Right-click the menu bar icon and choose **Open Log Folder** (**~/Library/Logs/dylanmaudio/Talk Light Trigger/**, newest 20 launches kept).
Send feedback	Also in the footer — a short message straight to me, no email client needed.

On Windows

Install	Run **Talk Light Trigger Setup**: it installs for you alone, with no administrator prompt. Start menu → **dylanmaudio** holds the app, this guide and the uninstaller. An update installs over the old one; if Talk Light is running, Setup offers to close it first (say No if a show is running).
MIDI Bridge	Talk Light reaches the console through **MIDI Bridge for Windows** (1.4.5 or later, free). Direct TCP and Existing MIDI Port aren't offered on Windows.
Audio input	The inputs listed are Windows' own (WASAPI), once each. A Dante Virtual Soundcard channel shows as **DVS Receive** with its channel numbers. Talk Light opens the device at the rate it is already running at and never changes it; in Windows' Sound settings a device's **Default Format** must match its driver's rate (Dante: the soundcard's), or it won't open.
Microphone access	Windows doesn't ask: Settings → Privacy & security → Microphone must have **Let desktop apps access your microphone** on. If it's off, Talk Light hears silence and the level stays at the bottom.
Remote Desktop	Connecting to this PC with Remote Desktop, or coming back to its own screen, resets Windows audio for a moment: Talk Light reopens its input by itself and carries on. Don't connect to a show PC while a show is running.
The tray icon	Windows puts a new tray icon under the **^** by the clock. Drag it onto the taskbar to keep it in view. Click and right-click work as the menu bar icon does above, and it pulses amber in the same cases. The first launch opens the panel for you.
Licence	The same licence as on the Mac: its two activations can be on either, or one of each.
Start at login	The same option in the panel. It also shows in Task Manager → Startup apps; switching it off there is respected.
Logs and settings	Logs: **%LOCALAPPDATA%\dylanmaudio\Logs\Talk Light Trigger** (Open Log Folder in the tray menu). Settings: **%APPDATA%\dylanmaudio\Talk Light Trigger**. Export log saves its zip to your Desktop and opens Explorer.
Uninstall	Start menu → dylanmaudio → Uninstall Talk Light Trigger, or Settings → Apps. It asks whether to remove your settings and logs too. Your licence stays activated either way.

What's new in v1.3.0

• New: Talk Light Trigger for Windows 10 and 11 (64-bit), in the system tray, with MIDI Bridge for Windows (1.4.5 or later). Your licence's two activations can be on a Mac or a PC.
• New: Talk Light Trigger now reaches your console through MIDI Bridge (1.4.5 or later), which is free and holds the one connection to the console for all your dylanmaudio apps. The Connection section is a single line saying whether the console is reached, with Open MIDI Bridge (or Get MIDI Bridge, if it isn't installed). The console's IP address and base MIDI channel are set once, in MIDI Bridge.
• New: the Cancel SoftKey works through MIDI Bridge. Until now it needed Direct TCP or another MIDI port. The Custom MIDI string the panel shows follows the base MIDI channel set in MIDI Bridge.
• New: if MIDI Bridge or the console goes away while Talk Light is running, the status tile turns red and says which, and the menu bar icon pulses amber, the colour MIDI Bridge shows while it connects. When the connection is back, the Scene for the current state is sent again, so the lights are right.
• New: on MIDI Bridge, Start doesn't wait for the console. It arms and listens, says in red that the console can't be reached yet, and the lights follow as soon as MIDI Bridge connects.
• Changed: Direct TCP and Existing MIDI Port still work in this version for setups that already use them, with a Move to MIDI Bridge button beside them. They will be removed in the next version. A setup already pointed at MIDI Bridge's MIDI port moves over by itself, and a new install starts on MIDI Bridge.